

**Learning Intention:** I can identify and use rhythm and onomatopoeia in poems.

**Success Criteria — I can:**

- Identify onomatopoeia words in a poem.
- Explain how rhythm affects how a poem sounds when read aloud.
- Use onomatopoeia in my own writing.

**Reading Strategy**

Read the poem aloud, or tap the beat as you read silently. Listen for words that sound like the noise they describe — these are **onomatopoeia**. Notice the **rhythm**, or pattern of beats, in each line.

**Read — Storm Over the Playground**

Boom! goes the thunder, crack goes the sky,  
Splish, splash, splatter as raindrops fly.  
Whoosh goes the wind through the old gum tree,  
Pitter-patter puddles form under our feet.  
  
We dash for the doorway, laughing and wet,  
Squelch go our shoes — the ground's a mess yet!  
Rumble and grumble, the storm rolls away,  
And out comes the sun on this wild, wet day.

**Vocabulary Helper**

| Word         | Meaning                                                           |
|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Onomatopoeia | A word that sounds like the noise it describes (e.g. buzz, crash) |
| Rhythm       | The pattern of beats or stresses in a line of poetry              |

**Identify — Find the Onomatopoeia**

Circle every onomatopoeia word you can find in the poem above. There are at least 8!

**Parent Tip**

Read the poem together and clap the rhythm of each line. Then go on a sound hunt around the house or garden — what onomatopoeia words could describe the sounds you hear?

**Try It**

Think of your own onomatopoeia word for a sound you hear often (at home, at school, outside). Write it here:

\_\_\_\_\_ What sound does it describe? \_\_\_\_\_

## Find It, Think About It &amp; Apply

## Q1 — List the Onomatopoeia

Write down every onomatopoeia word you circled on Page 1.

## Q2 — Match the Sound to the Onomatopoeia

| Sound source                    | Onomatopoeia word (write the letter) |
|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| A bee flying past               |                                      |
| A balloon popping               |                                      |
| Footsteps splashing in a puddle |                                      |

A = Bang   B = Splash   C = Buzz

## Q3 — Feel the Rhythm

Read this line aloud, clapping once for each stressed beat: "Boom! goes the thunder, crack goes the sky"

- a) How many claps (beats) did you count? \_\_\_\_\_
- b) Does the rhythm feel fast and sudden, or slow and calm? Why do you think the poet chose this rhythm for a storm poem?

\_\_\_\_\_

## Q4 — Complete the Poem Line

Choose an onomatopoeia word to complete each line.

- a) The old gate went \_\_\_\_\_ as it swung in the breeze. (creak / hop)
- b) The kettle began to \_\_\_\_\_ on the stove. (whistle / walk)
- c) Autumn leaves went \_\_\_\_\_ across the footpath. (rustle / sit)

## Watch Out!

Not every describing word is onomatopoeia — only words that actually **sound like** the noise count. "Loud" describes a sound but doesn't sound like one; "bang" does.

## Q5 — True or False?

| Statement                                   | True / False |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------|
| "Splash" is an example of onomatopoeia.     | True / False |
| Rhythm only matters in songs, not in poems. | True / False |

## Apply & Reasoning — Use what you've learned to explain your thinking.

- 1 Reasoning:** Why do poets use onomatopoeia instead of just describing a sound in ordinary words?

- 2 Reasoning:** How does the fast, punchy rhythm of "Storm Over the Playground" match its subject? What if it were written with a slow, gentle rhythm instead?

- 3 Create:** Write a short poem (4 lines) about a sound-filled place or event of your choice (a kitchen, a beach, a busy street). Use at least 2 onomatopoeia words.

## Quick Check — Exit Ticket

Write one onomatopoeia word not already used in this worksheet, and the sound it represents.

## Answer & Teacher Support

### Answer Key — Pages 1 & 2

**Identify (p1):** Boom, crack, splish, splash, splatter, whoosh, pitter-patter, squelch, rumble, grumble.

**Q1 (p2):** Any 5+ of the words listed above.

**Q2 (p2):** Bee — C (Buzz). Balloon popping — A (Bang). Splashing footsteps — B (Splash).

**Q3 (p2):** a) 8 beats (accept 7–9 depending on reading style). b) Fast and sudden — matches the sharp, exciting energy of a sudden storm.

**Q4 (p2):** a) creak. b) whistle. c) rustle.

**Q5 (p2):** "Splash is onomatopoeia" — True. "Rhythm only matters in songs" — False.

### Answer Key — Page 3

**Q1:** Onomatopoeia lets the reader almost "hear" the sound directly, making the poem more vivid and engaging than a plain description.

**Q2 (acceptable-answer guide):** Accept any answer noting the quick, punchy rhythm mirrors the suddenness/excitement of a storm; a slow rhythm would feel mismatched or calmer than the storm's energy.

**Q3 (acceptable-answer guide):** Accept any original 4-line poem with at least 2 genuine onomatopoeia words used appropriately.

**Exit ticket:** Accept any genuine onomatopoeia word with an accurate matching sound description (e.g. "sizzle — sound of frying").

### Teacher Checklist

- ☐ Identifies onomatopoeia words within a poem.
- ☐ Explains the effect of rhythm on a poem's feel.
- ☐ Selects appropriate onomatopoeia to complete a line.
- ☐ Explains why poets choose onomatopoeia over plain description.
- ☐ Writes an original short poem using onomatopoeia correctly.

### Teacher Tip

Reading the poem aloud together, with exaggerated sound effects, greatly helps students feel the rhythm and onomatopoeia before analysing them on paper. This worksheet pairs well with the "Weather Poem" writing task as a follow-up creative extension.